

▽ T-60

Date	1941	Country	Soviet Union
Weight	6.4 tons (5.8 tonnes)		
Engine	GAZ-202 6-cylinder diesel, 70 hp		
Main armament	20 mm TNSh cannon		

Intended to replace the prewar light tanks, the two-man T-60 was used as a reconnaissance vehicle. Early encounters with the Germans showed that it was under-gunned and too lightly armored. Adding thicker armor reduced its mobility, and the turret was too small to take a larger gun. It was unpopular, and gave way to the T-70.



Engine exhaust

20 mm TNSh cannon

Rubber-clad road wheels



△ T-70

Date	1942	Country	Soviet Union
Weight	10.1 tons (9.2 tonnes)		
Engine	2 x GAZ-202 6-cylinder diesel, 70 hp each		
Main armament	45 mm ZIS-19BM gun		

Although more heavily armed and armored than its predecessor (the T-60) the T-70 was still outclassed by the advanced German tanks. By 1943, the Soviets had realized that light tanks had no place on the battlefield, and relegated them to secondary roles. The SU-76 assault gun (see pp.110-11) was developed from the T-70 chassis.

▷ T-34/85

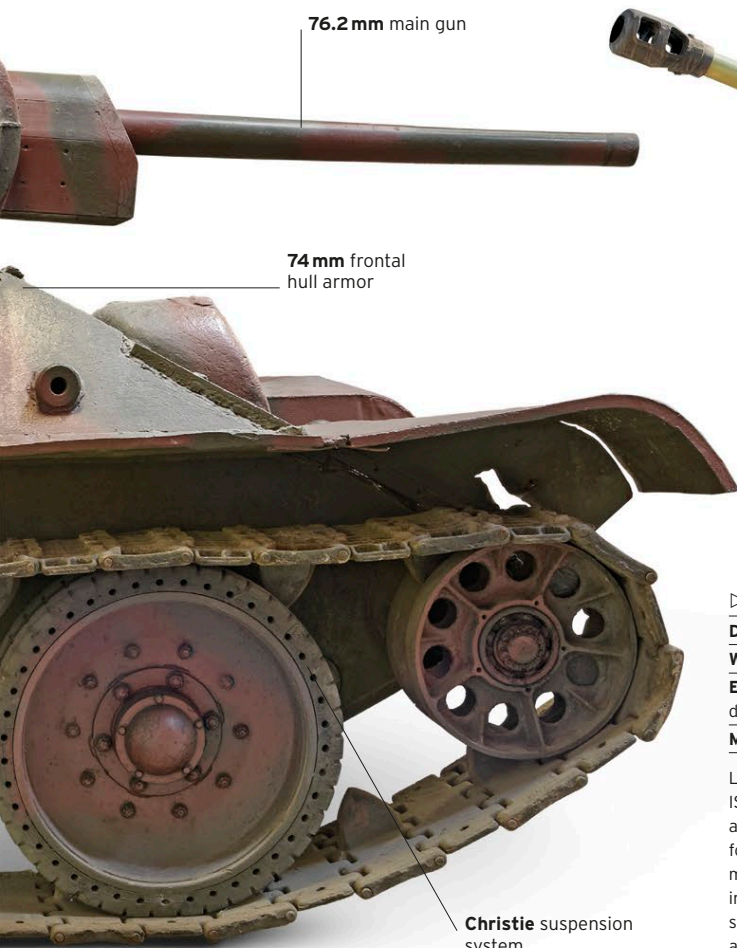
Date	1944	Country	Soviet Union
Weight	35.3 tons (32 tonnes)		
Engine	Kharkiv Model V-2-34 diesel, 500 hp		
Main armament	85 mm ZIS S-53 L/55 gun		

Despite its initial success, the T-34's shortcomings were clear by late 1943. Its two-man turret was too cramped for the crew to work effectively, and the gun was no longer sufficiently powerful. The T-34/85 resolved both of these issues. It went on to have a long postwar career with the Soviets and their client states, with one used in Yemen as late as 2015.



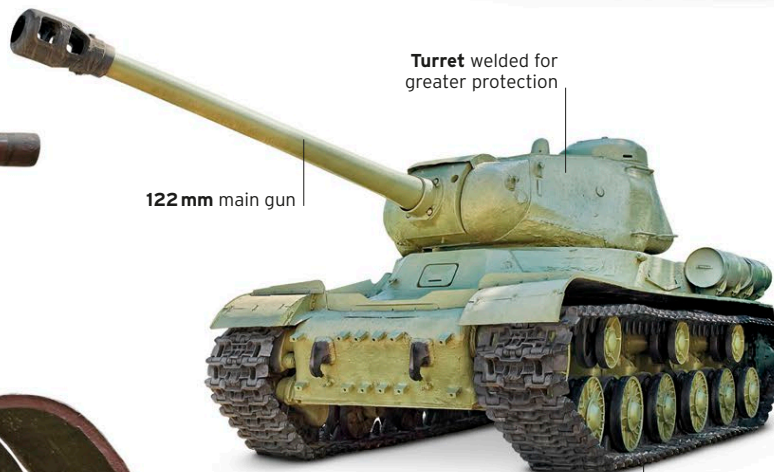
85 mm ZIS S-53 gun

External diesel fuel tanks



76.2 mm main gun

74 mm frontal hull armor



122 mm main gun

Turret welded for greater protection

Wide tracks

▷ Iosif Stalin-3M (IS-3M)

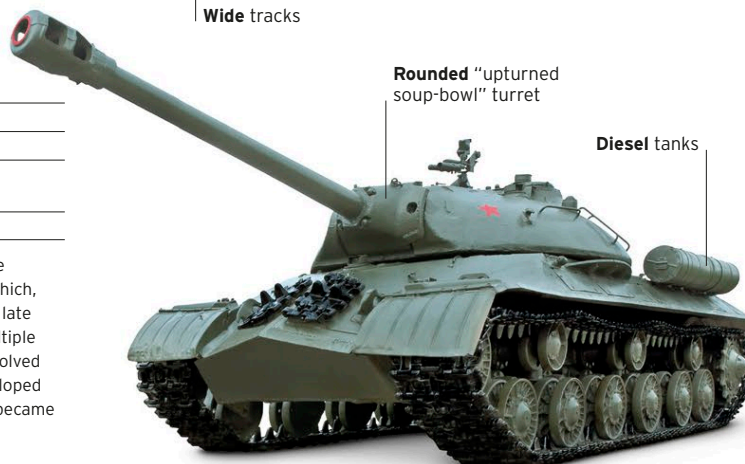
Date	1945	Country	Soviet Union
Weight	51.3 tons (46.5 tonnes)		
Engine	Kharkiv Model V-2IS diesel, 600 hp		
Main armament	122 mm D-25T L/45 gun		

Limitations in the speed and armor of the IS-2 led to the development of the IS-3, which, although rushed into service, arrived too late for World War II. Initially it developed multiple mechanical problems, but these were resolved in the improved IS-3M model. The IS-3's sloped sides gave better armor protection, and became a feature of postwar Soviet tank designs.

◁ Iosif Stalin-2 (IS-2)

Date	1944	Country	Soviet Union
Weight	49.3 tons (44.7 tonnes)		
Engine	Kharkiv Model V-2IS diesel, 520 hp		
Main armament	122 mm D-25T L/45 gun		

The need to face the threat of German Panthers and Tigers revitalized Soviet heavy tank production. The IS series was a development of the KV-1, with a new hull and transmission. On entering service, the IS-2 replaced both the IS-1 and the 85 mm-armed KV-85, and became organized into separate Heavy Tank Regiments. These were used to spearhead attacks on German positions.



Rounded "upturned soup-bowl" turret

Diesel tanks

Christie suspension system